

英語閱讀測驗與深度解析

主題：美國與歐洲信用卡安全技術（Chip-and-PIN）的發展差異

閱讀文章 (Article)

Last week Barack Obama issued an executive order requiring the federal government to issue new “chip-and-PIN” credit and debit cards as part of an effort to help “drive the market towards more secure payment systems.” European consumers, who are used to using PINs with their microchip-enabled credit cards, are no doubt aghast. Why has it taken America so long to adopt the anti-fraud measures that continental consumers have used for years?

America is the only rich country that still relies on outdated technology for most credit-card transactions. It is also the only one in which the market in counterfeit credit cards is still consistently growing. Retailers, banks and card issuers lost \$5.3 billion to credit-card fraud in America in 2012, about half the global total. Here's the trouble: upgrading cards is expensive. New card-readers are even dearer: upgrading all of the readers in America would cost hundreds of millions of dollars.

But America's reluctance to adopt the new technology is about more than just upfront costs. After all, European companies faced the same obstacles. There are two main reasons for the split. The first is technological. During the 1990s American credit-card companies got much better at detecting potentially fraudulent purchases and stopping them at the point of sale. Their European competitors didn't quite keep up. That meant Europe had a disproportionate incentive to switch to chip-and-PIN. The second difference is regulatory. Since European credit-card companies are responsible for paying most of the costs of fraud, they have a significant incentive to reduce it. American credit-card companies, which operate under looser regulations, have been able to pass on much of the cost of fraud to retailers and even consumers, and thus have had little incentive to spend money to reduce the costs of fraud.

Since retailers are responsible for a good chunk of the costs of fraud in America, they are now leading the way in making the switch to chip-and-PIN. Home Depot, Target, Walgreens and Walmart have already made the change, spending oodles of money on new chip-and-PIN-compatible card readers. The credit-card companies will keep up the pressure on retailers next October, when they begin requiring the party with the least-sophisticated technology to cover the cost of fraudulent transactions.

題目與詳解 (Questions & Analysis)

Question 1. What is the article mainly about?

- A. New credit card policy of Obama administration
- B. The more secure financial transactions in Europe
- C. Why America has been slow to adopt new technology
- D. The effect of chip-and-PIN credit cards on fraud reduction

正確答案：C

解析：本文核心在探討為何美國在採用「晶片與密碼（chip-and-PIN）」新技術上如此落後。第二段提到成本問題，第三段則具體分析了導致美歐差異（split）的兩大主因（技術與法規背景），故選 C。其餘選項僅為文中提及的局部事實或背景。

Question 2. The word “split” in paragraph 3 is closest in meaning to

- A. coincidence (巧合)
- B. difference (差異/分歧)
- C. comparison (比較)
- D. result (結果)

正確答案：B

解析：文中 “There are two main reasons for the split.” 指的是前文所說美國與歐洲在面對相同成本障礙時，卻採取不同技術路線的「分歧/差異」，後文隨即列出技術與法規上的兩大「不同點（difference）」，故選 B。

Question 3. Which is NOT the reason for America’s reluctance to change?

- A. Upgrading old system costs a lot of money.
- B. American card companies are not responsible for fraud losses.
- C. US and European card companies have been competing fiercely.
- D. America had more advanced anti-fraud technology in the 1990s.

正確答案：C

解析：文中提到美國不願更換的原因包括：A. 升級成本高昂（第二段）；B. 美國法規較鬆，信用卡公司可將詐欺成本轉嫁給零售商與消費者（第三段）；D. 1990年代美國在刷卡當下偵測詐欺的技術較歐洲先進，導致當時更換誘因不足（第三段）。文章並未提到美歐信用卡公司之間有「激烈競爭」，故選 C。

Question 4. What will happen next October?

- A. Retailers will be responsible for the costs of fraud in America.
- B. Credit-card companies will put pressure on politicians.
- C. Retailers will switch to chip-and-PIN.
- D. Those with the least advanced technology will pay for fraud costs.

正確答案：D

解析：根據最後一段最後一句，“...requiring the party with the least-sophisticated technology to cover the cost of fraudulent transactions”，即明年十月起，技術最落後、最不發達的那一方必須承擔詐欺損失的成本，故選 D。

參考譯文 (Chinese Translation)

上週，歐巴馬政府發布了一項行政命令，要求聯邦政府發行新型的「晶片與密碼（chip-and-PIN）」信用卡和金融卡，以作為推動市場走向更安全支付系統努力的一部分。早已習慣在微晶片信用卡上配合密碼使用的歐洲消費者，無疑會感到震驚。為什麼美國花了這麼長時間，才採用歐洲大陸消費者已經使用多年的反詐欺措施？

美國是唯一在大多數信用卡交易中仍依賴過時技術的富裕國家，也是唯一偽造信用卡市場仍在持續增長的國家。2012年，美國的零售商、銀行和發卡機構因信用卡詐欺損失了53億美元，約占全球總額的一半。問題在於：升級卡片的成本很高，而新型讀卡機更加昂貴——升級美國所有的讀卡機將耗資數億美元。

然而，美國不願採用新技術的原因不僅僅是前期的成本問題，畢竟歐洲公司也面臨著同樣的障礙。造成這種分歧主要有兩個原因：第一是技術上的。在1990年代，美國信用卡公司在檢測潛在詐欺性消費並在銷售點及時阻止方面，技術變得先進許多，而其歐洲競爭對手並未完全跟上，這意味著歐洲有更大的誘因轉向晶片與密碼技術。第二個差異是法規上的。由於歐洲信用卡公司必須承擔大部分的詐欺成本，因此他們有極大的動力去減少詐欺；而在較寬鬆法規下運營的美國信用卡公司，則能將大部分詐欺成本轉嫁給零售商甚至消費者，因此幾乎沒有動力花錢來降低詐欺成本。

由於零售商承擔了美國很大一部分的詐欺成本，他們現在正引領向晶片與密碼技術的轉變。家得寶（Home Depot）、目標百貨（Target）、沃爾格林（Walgreens）和沃爾瑪（Walmart）等已經做出了改變，投入大量資金購買相容的新型讀卡機。信用卡公司將在明年十月繼續對零售商施加壓力，屆時他們將開始要求技術最落後的一方來承擔詐欺交易的損失。